

Study Abroad for Scientists

Land Sciences

May, 2026

Study Abroad for Scientists (A34061)

Short Title:	Study Abroad for Scientists	
Faculty	Science and Computing	
Department	Land Sciences	
Cluster	Placement and Projects	
Author	TKENT	
Credits	30	Level: Intermediate

Description of Module / Aims

The Study Abroad module is offered to students to strengthen their studies through experiencing learning in an international environment. This module will enable the student to benefit from studying and living abroad by developing intercultural awareness and competence through reflection on the experience, enhancing personal development and allowing scope to transfer the knowledge and skills acquired to both academic and future work. It will allow expansion of the student's programme-specific knowledge and understanding, and awareness of operating in an international context. Where appropriate, this module will enhance the student's language skills and aid the student in developing strategies for more effective language learning.

Programmes

SCIE-0086	BSc (Hons) in Agricultural Science (WD_SAGRI_B)	3 / 6 / E
SCIE-0086	BSc (Hons) in Food Science and Innovation (WD_SFSIN_B)	3 / 5 / E
SCIE-0086	BSc (Hons) in Molecular Biology with Biopharmaceutical Science (WD_SMBIO_B)	3 / 6 / E
SCIE-0086	BSc (Hons) in Pharmaceutical Science (WD_SPHSC_B)	3 / 6 / E
SCIE-0086	BSc in Food Science with Business (WD_SFDSC_D)	3 / 5 / E
SCIE-0086	BSc in Forestry (WD_SFORS_D)	2 / 4 / E

Indicative Content

- The student will receive pre-departure support in preparing for a successful study abroad semester.
- The student will prepare a learning agreement detailing the modules of study (minimum 20 ECTS) chosen to be relevant to the student's programme and agreed with the Study Abroad Co-ordinator before departure. The student may elect, subject to approval in the learning agreement, to take more than the minimum 20 ECTS in modules at the host institute. Language and/or culture studies may form part of the Study Abroad learning agreement where appropriate.
- Students will be required to attend classes in the host institute and undertake all assignments and examinations required. Credits earned will be worth up to a minimum of 20 ECTS for the semester.
- Up to a further 10 ECTS will be awarded for the completion of a study abroad portfolio containing a set of reflective journals detailing the international study experience and outlining personal and professional understanding, learning and growth. Documented evidence of language learning and/or a presentation summarising the student's experience may also form part of the portfolio. The maximum ECTS awarded to this module will be 30 ECTS.

Learning Outcomes

On successful completion of this module, a student will be able to:

1. Demonstrate competency in the modules undertaken in the host institute as per the learning agreement amounting to at least 20 ECTS credits (or equivalent).
2. Develop cross-cultural communication skills, potentially including second language skills.
3. Demonstrate an ability to reflect critically on the independent learning and self-management that studying abroad requires.
4. Compose a study abroad portfolio consisting of a set of reflective journals, detailing their study experience, and outlining their personal and professional understanding, learning and growth. A presentation summarising the student's experience may also form part of the portfolio.

Learning and Teaching Methods

- The range and variety of teaching and learning methods will depend on the modules studied at the partner institution. However, it is expected to consist of lectures, practical classes, group work, assignments, and examinations.
- In addition to study and assessment at the partner institution, a reflective log or journal of learning and cultural experiences and/or presentation (portfolio) will be submitted to the SETU Study Abroad Co-ordinator for assessment on completion of the study abroad period.

Assessment Methods

	Weighing	Outcomes Assessed
Continuous Assessment	100%	
<i>In-Class Assessment</i>	67%	1, 2
<i>Portfolio</i>	33%	3, 4

Assessment Criteria

Pass: Student obtains 20 ECTS from host institute and adequate student portfolio submitted within the appropriate deadlines.

Fail: Student fails to obtain 20 ECTS from host institute and/or does not submit an adequate portfolio.

Learning Modes

Learning Mode	F/T Hours	P/T Hours
Independent Learning	810	

Essential Material

- "Study Abroad for Scientists module page on Moodle." www.setu.ie. <https://moodle.wit.ie/>

Supplementary Material

- "Information for Outgoing Erasmus students." www.setu.ie. <https://www.wit.ie/international/erasmus-non-eu-exchange/outgoing-erasmus-students/>
- "Studying and Working Abroad." <https://gradireland.com/>. <https://gradireland.com/search/advice?search=international%2520abroad>

- Berdan, S. N., A. Goodman and C. Taylor. *_A student's guide to study abroad._* New York: The Institute of International Education, 2013.